

Negative Team: Responsibilities and Speaker Duties

First Negative (or Negative) Constructive Speech

Start with an Introduction that introduces your topic and states that you see flaws in the proposition's case –

- **Example:** *While “exploring alternative energy sources” may presently seem like the PC thing to do, developing these sources will be extremely expensive. It is for this reason and others, we stand opposed to the resolution.*

Next, provide your “roadmap” (an outline) of what you will cover in the next few minutes.

- **Example:** *In the next few minutes, I will: 1) discuss some concerns we have with how the AFF framed of the debate, 2) present the Negative case, and 3) return to the Affirmative's case and show why it is flawed. Turning first to the Affirmative's framing of the debate....*

Agree or disagree with the AFF's framing – with their labeling of the proposition, with the judging criteria they want the judge to use, and/or with the definitions. Sometimes you have no problem with the way they framed the debate. If that is the case, say so. But you may have some issues with the framing. Here is an example of what you might say if you didn't like either the labeling of the proposition or the judging criteria suggested by the Affirmative

- **Example:** *The Affirmative told you this is a policy debate, and we are in agreement on this. However, they want the judging criteria to be preponderance of evidence. We believe that evidence can always be found to support an argument, and we prefer that the judge use net benefits. In other words, judge us on the number and quality of the benefits we secure for the American people.*

The most common concern with the framing of the debate is how the Affirmative defined the terms. Attack them if you feel their definitions don't reflect the purpose or INTENT of the resolution. In other words, if you were debate with their definition of terms, you wouldn't really be debating what the resolution intended. This is a TOPICALITY argument – more on that in a later chapter. If you feel the AFF only talked about one part of the proposition and they need to talk about the entire topic, then attack them. In our example above the Affirmative excluded nuclear power as an alternative energy source.” You might want to argue this.

- **Example:** *We disagree with the Affirmative's definition of alternative energy sources. They exempted “nuclear power” from their definition. Clearly, most of our power comes from oil, making nuclear power technology clearly an “alternate” energy source. The AFF has purposefully kept it out of the definition because nuclear power is both costly and detrimental, as we will show you later. So we need to redefine alternate energy sources to include nuclear power, and it is on that definition that the Negative will debate.*

Present the Negative's case – Each Negative team should have developed at least 2 – 3 arguments that support the negative position. Presenting the Negative case first insures that you have your arguments in early in case you were to run out of time. You want the arguments you choose to be unique to the Negative side.

- **Example:** *Now let's turn to the Negative's two contentions. Number #1 – Developing alternate energy sources will cost far too much money – money that could be better spent on other things.*

Of course, some of your Negative case arguments may apply to the Affirmative arguments. If you can use them to break down AFF arguments, you can let the judge know that you will be referring to this argument again later in the debate. For instance, you might say, “Now remember this analysis because I will refer to it later when refuting the Affirmative case.” Other teams also refer to this as “cross applying a point” – This is essentially where you use previous information or arguments to attack a different appoint. For examples, a team member

says, “As we consider the Affirmative’s first argument on the benefits of solar power, we would like you to cross apply our first negative argument on the huge cost of alternate energy sources -- solar energy being one of those. Solar energy may be nice, but it is going to cost WAY TOO MUCH.”

If the Affirmative presented a plan, you will need to attack it.

- **Example:** *The Affirmative’s plan will not solve the harms and will actually be harmful to the public. First,*

Next move to the Affirmative’s case and **ATTACK** each point in the order that they were presented. Caution – sometimes the first negative spends so much time presenting their Negative arguments that they don’t leave time to attack the Affirmative’s case. You must watch the clock so that you save time for the Affirmative attack – this is crucial.

- **Example:** *The Affirmative’s first contention is that we are too dependent on foreign oil. We would argue first that the Negative shows you no HARM in this. They present no examples of where our dependence has led to a significant harm to U.S. citizens. Second, we argue that the U.S. is already taking steps to minimize our need to get oil from other countries. We are looking to sources within our own country. Statistics show that the U.S. has enough of its own supplies to last for hundreds of years...*

After you have completed your case, you quickly summarize your key points and urge a vote for the Negative.

- **Example:** *Because the Affirmative has a faulty definition of terms and has presented arguments that are flawed AND because we have provided two solid arguments supporting the need to value economic considerations, we ask for a Negative ballot.*

First Negative Speaker Checklist

- ☐ I have given a short Introduction
- ☐ I have stated that we are opposed to the resolution.
- ☐ I have provided a road map
- ☐ I have explained our problems with the way the Affirmative framed the debate
 - ☐ If I didn’t like the way they labeled the type of motion, I explained why
 - ☐ If I didn’t like the judging criteria, I have explained why and suggested another one
 - ☐ If I didn’t like the Definition of Terms, I explained why and offered others.
- ☐ I have presented at least 2 negative contentions
- ☐ If it is a policy debate, I have argued my problems with the Affirmative plan
- ☐ I have attacked each of the Affirmative’s claims or contentions
- ☐ I have given a conclusion

Second Negative (or Negative) Constructive Speech

Start with an opening line and reaffirm the negative position.

- **Example:** *If you asked a guy in the unemployment line, a woman in front of her foreclosed home, a young adult with huge college loans – Alternate energy sources or economic prosperity? -- I think we know what they would answer. Economic security, along with the other arguments we’ve presented show why the Negative is against this resolution.*

Next give a roadmap of your speech – tell the judge what order you will be discussing things.

- **Example:** *Here's where I'll be going during the next 8 minutes. I will first handle our continued problem with the definition of terms, then move to the attacks on our negative contentions, showing you why they aren't valid, and finally I will go back up to the top of the flow to deal with the Affirmative's case. Turning now to the unreasonable definition of terms....*

If you're still not happy with any parts of the framing of the debate, extend on the arguments presented by the AFF. Don't simply repeat what your partner said.

Go to the Negative Case first. Discuss the contentions your partner brought up. Deal with each response made by the Affirmative to those contentions. REBUILD them so they are airtight again – they may have been shredded by the Affirmative's attack but now is the time to fix and rebuild them. Point out to the judge if they have been dropped. Again, don't just repeat what has been said by your partner, answer the attacks of the Affirmative. EXTEND!

- **Example:** *The Affirmative said it is better to stimulate the economy through job creation, but we don't believe that many jobs will come from job creation in the alternate energy resource sector. First, most of the initial jobs will be for specially trained scientists and engineers – those groups aren't the ones hurting for jobs right now – they aren't the ones who need them. Second, the jobs created will only last if the company lasts. Look at Solyndra – Obama poured billions into that company and it went bankrupt. When it did, so did the jobs that it created. And finally, we need a STOP GAP measure because jobs are needed now – not in 10 years.*

If this is a policy debate, now is the time to again discuss and extend on the problems with the Affirmative's plan. Show why your concerns are valid, answer AFF attacks.

Next go back to the Affirmative contentions that were rebuilt during the 2nd Affirmative speech. Guess what – you need to tear down what they just rebuilt.

- **Example:** *The Affirmative told you that dependence on oil was bad, and we responded that we needed to see the harm in this. The Affirmative responds that there have been recent hikes in oil prices and that the U.S. is at the mercy of oil rich countries. In response, we would argue that energy prices will certainly be higher under their case. Companies that research and develop alternate energy sources must recoup their expenses, and they will hit up the American taxpayer to get them. Those costs are likely to be higher than the current price of oil. As to being at the mercy of oil rich countries, we would argue that those countries need us as much as we need them. Their economies are almost exclusively based on their oil sales, so they need us, and they need to set fair market values.*

Finally, summarize the Negative position for the judge.

- **Example:** *Remember this debate is on what do we value most – alternate energy sources or economic prosperity for our citizens. While solar and wind energy seem nice, we have clearly shown that we need to place a priority on our ailing economy and protect our citizens. The Affirmative doesn't present a significant harm, while we have presented benefits to our citizens NOW – the choice is clear, and it is a vote for the Negative.*

Second Negative Speaker Checklist

- ☐ I have given a short Introduction line
- ☐ I have re-affirmed that we are opposed to the resolution.
- ☐ I have provided a road map
- ☐ If we didn't like how the Affirmative framed the debate, I have explained our problems

one last time.

☐ If we didn't like how they labeled the type of motion, I have extended on our argument.

☐ If we didn't like their judging criteria, I have extended on why ours is better.

☐ If we didn't like their Def of Terms, I have extended on why ours are more fair

☐ I have rebuilt the negative case by extending and answering the attacks by the Affirmative

☐ If it is a policy debate, I have explained why we still have concerns with their plan

☐ I have again explained the weaknesses in each of the AFF arguments through extending on the 2nd

AFF Analysis

☐ I have pointed out the flaws in the AFF analysis

☐ I have extended arguments – not just repeated what my partner said

☐ I have given a conclusion